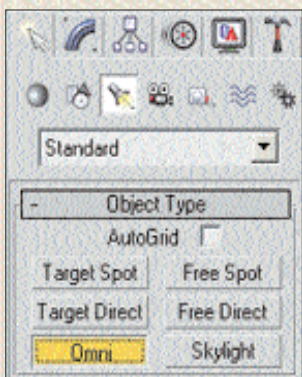


by moving it to the left of the X-axis in the front viewport. Use the camera viewport to move it till you are satisfied with the framing. You can also change the property of the noise strength by right-clicking on the X position name and selecting properties. Change the values of Roughness and Strength to get variations. A small feature called Ramp in and Ramp out allows you to smoothen the start and end movements. Preview your animation at this stage and save the file as tech7.max

Using Skylight

Now we can set up the basic lights required for the animation. Choose an Omni light from the lights pane. Position this to the right of the camera and in front of the object group. Reduce the multiplier intensity of the light to 0.5 in the light properties box.

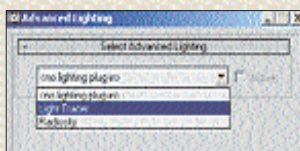
To make your illumination convincing and softer, use Skylights. Click on the Skylight button in the Create lights rollout. Create this



Let there be light

light anywhere in the scene since the effect isn't based on its position. You need to activate the Advanced lighting control to use the Skylight's lighting property. To do so, go to **Rendering > Advanced lighting**, and select Light Tracer.

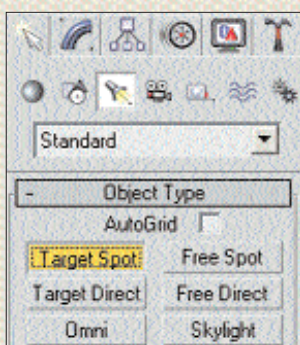
Next, create a spotlight using the create Spot Target



The magical light meter

in the lights create panel. Use the Top viewport to create light from the left of the camera, pointing towards the group object. From the Left viewport, move the target upwards, pointing to the centre of the group.

Here's a special feature that lets you project an



The focus beam light

image onto this object. Select the spotlight and open Advanced Effects from the Modify Light panel. Click None to open the Material/Map browser window. Select Bitmap and press

OK. Select a bitmap image file from your image resource and press OK.

Notice that the image name is shown in the Projector Map box. Open the spotlight parameters in the Modify Lights panel. Choose rectangle as the option for the shape of the spotlight. Use the Bitmap Fit button to automatically resize the rectangle of the spotlight to the rectangular proportion of the projected image again.

You can also change the Hotspot/Beam and Falloff/Field values to adjust the coverage area of the spotlight.

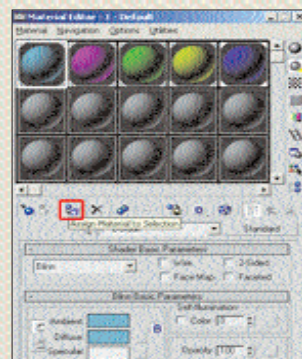
Render the scene. You will see the projected image rendered onto the group object. To make the animation interesting, animate the spot target from the Front viewport on the X-axis and Y-axis. Save the file as tech8.max.

Texturing shapes for a colourful final animation

The animation will look very colourful and contemporary if we can assign a different colour for each square.

To apply colour maps, first open the group object. select it and go to **Group > Open** from the menu bar. Now, select each shape one by one and apply different colours using the Material editor.

Open the Material editor by pressing [M]. Select the first sample sphere and change the diffuse colour to blue. Select the shape at the extreme-left and top of the

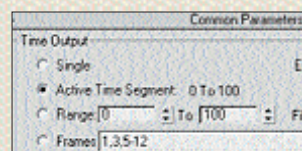


The ultimate makeup toolkit

opened group and click on 'Assign Material to Selection'.

Create 5 such colours in the Material editor and assign it to each object. Render a single frame to see the result.

You are now ready to render the entire animation. Select the Camera viewport and hit the Render Scene button on the toolbar. Select the Active Time segment of 100 frames. Select the custom file size of 320 x 200 pixels. In the Render Output section select the Save File option and enter the filename as render. Select MOV - Quick-



Ready to render

time as the Save As type. Hit the render button and enjoy your Pogo animation.

Remember to render in D1 PAL size, ie, 720 x 576 pixels for professional television-quality outputs. Also, remember that the television format requires 25 frames per second. Happy Animating!